

PURPOSE: To give students flexibility when choosing days off from attending study hours, which are awarded by their privilege plan.

INTRODUCED BY: Carys Peden

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

Currently, MSMS students are awarded days in which they do not have to attend study hours according to the privilege plan they have received for the quarter. Once given their privilege plans, students must pick the days of the week in which they do not attend study hours for the entire quarter. Residential staff then punches a hole in the days a student chooses off, signifying that a student can only miss study hours on those certain days. This system can be conflicting for a lot of students' schedules because new events occur at MSMS or in a student's life almost every week which may force students to sacrifice a day they chose as an off day to tend to these new circumstances (examples of these circumstances could include the following: a student is suddenly not doing so well in a subject which they have always excelled in and now has to attend tutorials on a night that coincides with a night that the student can miss study hours; a student suddenly remembers a friend's birthday is at the end of the quarter, but the student has already used their general purpose sign-outs and their friend's birthday celebration does not coincide with the days which a student has selected off of study hours; etc.). Students should not be required to choose their schedule for an entire nine weeks and sacrifice unalterable study hours off which they have earned because of the frequent, short-notice happenings which occur in students' lives. In summary, this system gives students privileges which they cannot fully harness because of the unsteady and ever-changing nature of life's occurrences.

SECTION TWO (PROPOSED ACTION):

To allow students to take full advantage of their awarded privileges, students should be able to choose the days on which they do not attend study hours on a weekly basis. This approach would give students a better idea of which days they are free from academic or personal happenings out of the week and provide students with a flexible enough schedule to enjoy time away from campus with friends and family. This new system could be achieved by a student showing residential staff his or her privilege plan card; staff would then either mark a certain symbol, a star or SH (standing for study hours) for example, by the date on students' off-campus yellow cards to signify

that a student has used one of his or her awarded days off, or staff could keep up with these special off-campus sign-outs on a different sheet (an example is shown below). These small changes would improve the lives of MSMS students by providing needed flexibility.

Used during the week of: _____ 4/1-6/24 _____

(below is an example that could include a table of students' names in alphabetical order, and there could be separate sheets for each floor/wing)

STUDENTS	DAYS AWARDED	DAYS/ DATES USED
Bridgerton, Charles	1	4/2/24
Perkins, Lola	2	4/2/24 4/4/24
Salvatore, Stefan	0	
Smith, Carrie	2	4/5/24

SECTION THREE (APPENDIX):

Response 1 (Anonymous):

It's a good idea because I wanted to go to Tales because I haven't left campus at all this week, and I had to use a general-purpose sign-out, but if this was a thing I just could have used one of my study hours off.

Response 2 (Anonymous):

Honestly, I think they should get rid of the punch card because it is silly to choose one day and have to stick with it when various things often pop up in my schedule.

Response 3 (Anonymous):

I chose Tuesdays and Thursdays as my days off, but I got mandatory tutorials on Thursday for a certain subject. When I asked ResLife if I could change my day off from Thursday to Wednesday, they told me that the hole-punch mark was permanent, and they wouldn't change it. It just sucks because I earned having that second day off this quarter, and now I can't use it.